

Kingston U3 DataTraveler Smart USB Flash drive

Applications On The Move



Kingston's 2 GB, U3 offering is a smart looking, a true data carrier the U3 feature means you'll be able to carry around your software and their preferences around for use on any computer you plug it into! Once you've installed any software on a U3 drive, it allows you to access that software on any computer.

The drive comes with an application called Launchpad. It allows you to manage programs, install

programs and access data. There's also software that allows you to password-protect data. The drive also comes loaded with Pass2Go—a portable version of RoboForm, as trialware for 60 days, ACDSee limited version, and Zinio magazine reader as trialware for four issues. There are various software available at U3 Software Central and Kingston's Software Center, where you are taken to with one click.

When we tested this plug-and-play drive, Launchpad came up. It

showed two drives, the first as a USB Flash drive and the second as a CD drive with different drive letters. We downloaded an application from U3 Software Central and installed it. We then tried using the drive on different computers to check for portability, and it worked like a charm.

In our tests, the drive showed good read/write speeds. As of now, the U3 feature works only with Windows 2000/XP. Warranty is five years.

Specifications

2 GB storage capacity, USB 2.0 interface, 2.64 x 0.80 x 0.35 inches

Contact: Kingston Technology
Phone: 022-26592961
E-mail: techsupport_india@kingston.com.tw
Web site: www.kingston.com.tw
Price: Rs 2,990

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

BenQ-Siemens CL-71

A slick looker

The CL-71 is part of the crop of cell phones post the BenQ-Siemens merger. It is a tri-band phone that's neat-looking to boot, with a slider-type form factor. The phone is clad in black and silver, with emphasis on the black. Typical of slider phones, the navigational buttons are decently-laid-out, with the left and right and call accept / reject buttons being quite large and easily accessible. The button feel is tacky though.

The phone slider is slick; once opened, it reveals a 1.3 MP camera which offers

decent shot quality. The number keypad is good, and is much better than the outer keys. We say "good" because slider phones typically have cramped number pads. The keypad backlight is a soothing blue and very evenly lit.

The screen sports a spec of 262,000 colours at a resolution of 176 x 220. We noticed that the screen doesn't really live up to its specs—even some of the default wallpapers had colour gradations.

The CL-71 comes with 24 MB of onboard memory, and memory is upgradeable via micro SD TransFlash. On the music front, the phone supports the MP3, AAC and WMA formats. The bundled earphones are just about decent. The CL-71 has the

9-icon (3 x 3) layout, meaning a lot of functions are bundled together under a single menu icon, some of which don't make sense.

With the usual array of call features available, the CL-71 makes a good fashion statement, though it's not quite as curvy as some would like. At Rs 12,799, we think the CL-71 is overpriced.

Specifications

GSM tri-band, USB and Bluetooth, 176 x 220 TFT, 262K colours, 24 MB internal memory, micro SD expandable, 115 gm

Contact: BenQ India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-41601707
E-mail: salesenquiryin@benq.com
Web site: www.benq.co.in
Price: Rs 12,799



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★